

PROLOGUE.....	27
Introduction – “Prayer, the First Resort”	28
 Breakfast Edition Month 1 – Esther.....	29
Second <i>IS</i> the Best	29
 Appetizer – Instead of, Est 2:17	29
 Main Course — The Call, the Crisis, and the Courage.....	30
 Bite 1 – Mordecai’s Warning, Est 4:13–14	30
 Bite 2 – Fasting Before the Move, Est 4:15–16.....	30
 Bite 3 – The Turnaround, Esther 8:7.....	30
 BM1 — Lesson 2: Solomon	34
 The Question That Unlocked a Legacy.....	34
 Appetizer — When God Says, “Ask Me for Anything”, 1 Kings 3:5–7	34
 Main Course	35
 Bite 1 — Humble Heart of a King, 1 Kings 3:9-10	35
 Bite 2 — God’s Response, 2 Chron 1:11–12.....	35
 Bite 3 — A Legacy That Starts in Prayer, 1 Kings 4:29–30	36
 BM1 — Lesson 3: Jesus	38
 Prayer the First Resort	38
 Appetizer — WWJD: What Would Jesus Do? Luke 5:15–16.....	38
 Main Course – The Mediator and the Model.....	38
 Bite 1 — “Lord, Teach Us to Pray”, Luke 11:1–4.....	38
 Bite 2 — Don’t Quit Praying, Luke 18:1–5	39
 Bite 3 — God Is Not Like the Unjust, Judge, Luke 18:6–8.....	39
 BM1 — Lesson 4 Paul & Silas	42
 Faith in the Dark	42
 Appetizer – The Mindset is Everything, Isa 26:3	42
 Main Course – Power in the Praises	42
 Bite 1 – The Test in Their Testament, Acts 16:22–24, 31	42
 Bite 2 – The Jailhouse Rocked, Acts 16:25–26.....	43
 Bite 3 – Contagious Praise, Collective Breakthrough, Acts 16:27–30.....	43

 Appendix – Breakfast Month 1 Answer Key	47
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Lesson 1 – Esther: Second Is the Best.....	47
Lesson 2 – Solomon: The Question That Unlocked a Legacy	48
Lesson 3 – Jesus: Prayer the First Resort.....	48
Lesson 4 – Paul & Silas: Faith in the Dark.....	49
Lesson 1 – Esther: Second Is the Best.....	47
Lesson 2 – Solomon: The Question That Unlocked a Legacy	48
Lesson 3 – Jesus: Prayer the First Resort.....	48
Lesson 4 – Paul & Silas: Faith in the Dark.....	49
Lesson 1 – Esther: Second Is the Best.....	47
Lesson 2 – Solomon: The Question That Unlocked a Legacy	48
Lesson 3 – Jesus: Prayer the First Resort.....	48
Lesson 4 – Paul & Silas: Faith in the Dark.....	49
Lesson 1 – Esther: Second Is the Best.....	47
Lesson 2 – Solomon: The Question That Unlocked a Legacy	48
Lesson 3 – Jesus: Prayer the First Resort.....	48
Lesson 4 – Paul & Silas: Faith in the Dark.....	49

All scriptures are from the World English Bible (WEB) unless otherwise noted.

PROLOGUE

“Prayer for Divine Connection”

In the quiet of my heart, I seek Your face,
Elohim, Jesus Christ, fountain of grace.
Through ancient paths where prophets once trod,
I reach beyond the veil to touch my God.

Your Word, a lamp that guides through darkest night,
Transforms my weakness into holy might.
The Holy Spirit breathes where faith is born,
Three persons, one God—Father, Spirit, Son.

In perfect unity, the Trinity divine,
The Comforter within, Your presence mine.
The body of Christ, united as one,
Brother and sister beneath Your sun.

In family ties, both blood and spirit-bound,
Your kingdom's strength on earth is found.
When others stumble, empathy extends my hand,
With sympathy I weep, I pray, I stand.

The Spirit intercedes with groans too deep for words,
An advocate whose whispers always heard.
For we are woven in Your love's design,
Each thread of mercy, wholly Thine.

Through sacrifice You broke sin's heavy chain,
Now in Your presence, I am born again.
The Spirit seals us, marked as heaven's own,
Until we stand before the eternal throne.

-S. L. Doctor

Introduction – “Prayer, the First Resort”

“In nothing be anxious, but in everything, by prayer and petition with thanksgiving, let your requests be made known to God. -Phil 4:6 (WEB)

Before we can truly walk with God, we must first learn to talk with Him. Prayer is not simply a religious routine or a spiritual exercise—it is the first resort that ushers us into a genuine, living relationship with our Creator. From the very beginning, God desired fellowship with humanity, and prayer is the divine pathway through which that fellowship is restored and maintained.



When we pray, we are not informing God of what He does not know; rather, we are inviting Him into the center of our hearts, our situations, and our lives. Prayer is the language of dependence, the heartbeat of faith, and the foundation of intimacy with the Father. It is through prayer that our hearts are softened, our minds are renewed, and our will begins to align with His.

Jesus Himself modeled this truth. Before every major decision, miracle, and moment of ministry, He withdrew to pray (Luke 5:16). His life demonstrated that relationship with the Father was sustained through continual communion. If the Son of God needed prayer to remain connected, how much more do we?

Prayer is not the result of a relationship—it is the beginning of it. It is the open door into knowing God personally, hearing His voice, and walking in His purpose. As we begin this study, let us approach prayer not as a duty but as an invitation—a sacred escort leading us deeper into the presence and love of God.

SOUL FOOD BIBLE STUDY

Breakfast Edition Month 1 – Esther

Second /S the Best

 **Theme:** Prayer, the First Resort

 **Background Text:** Esther 1–4 (focus on chapters 2–4)

 **Key Verse:** Esther 4:14 (WEB)

“For if you remain silent now, then relief and deliverance will come to the Jews from another place, but you and your father’s house will perish. **Who knows if you haven’t come to the kingdom for such a time as this?**”

Appetizer – Instead of, Est 2:17

“The king loved Esther more than all the women, and she obtained favor and kindness in his sight more than all the virgins; so that he set the royal crown on her head, and made her queen instead of Vashti.” --Esther 2:17

Queen Vashti was breathtaking, bold, and unapologetically defiant — so when King Ahasuerus (Xerxes) summoned her to show off her beauty, she refused. Her refusal cost her the crown. A kingdom-wide search began for her replacement. Esther, a Jewish orphan raised by her cousin Mordecai, was chosen and crowned queen — not by luck, but divine placement.

Meanwhile, Haman was promoted, and the king commanded people to bow before him. Everyone complied except Mordecai. His refusal — rooted in the Ten Commandments — enraged Haman, who immediately plotted genocide.

CST Reflection:

Have you ever faced backlash for simply doing the right thing?



Main Course — The Call, the Crisis, and the Courage



Bite 1 – Mordecai’s Warning, Est 4:13–14

“Then Mordecai asked them to return this answer to Esther: ‘Don’t think to yourself that you will escape in the king’s house any more than all the Jews. For if you remain silent now, then relief and deliverance will come to the Jews from another place, but you and your father’s house will perish.

Who knows if you haven’t come to the kingdom for such a time as this?’”

Esther learns that her crown cannot shield her from Haman’s decree. Mordecai positions her heart: This is bigger than beauty. Bigger than privilege. This is purpose.

□ CST Reflection:

When have you realized that your position was actually an assignment?



Bite 2 – Fasting Before the Move, Est 4:15–16

“Go, gather together all the Jews who are present in Susa, and **fast for me**, and neither eat nor drink three days, night or day. I also and my maidens will fast in the same way. Then I will go in to the king, which is against the law; and if I perish, I perish.”

Esther requested a three-day fast — not a last resort, but a spiritual repositioning. Fasting clarifies. Fasting strengthens. Fasting shifts atmospheres. God was aligning Esther’s courage with divine timing.



Fasting Note: Always consult your pastor and doctor before engaging in fasting if you have health concerns.

□ CST Reflection:

What personal “fear barrier” do you need to fast through?



Bite 3 – The Turnaround, Esther 8:7

⁷Then King Ahasuerus said to Esther the queen and to Mordecai the Jew, “See, I have given Esther the house of Haman, and they have hanged him on the gallows because he laid his hand on the Jews. ⁸Write also to the Jews as it pleases you, in the king’s name, and seal it with the king’s ring; for the writing which is written in the king’s name, and sealed with the king’s ring, may not be reversed by any man.”

The same gallows Haman built for Mordecai became the tool of his own undoing.

When Esther stepped into purpose, God shifted everything:

- A decree reversed
- A nation rescued
- The enemy exposed
- Honor restored

□ **CST Reflection:**

Where in your life can God turn evil intentions into divine promotion?

 Dessert – God Works ALL Things Together, Rom 8:28

“We know that all things work together for good for those who love God, to those who are called according to his purpose.”

Esther didn’t come from royalty — she walked into it through obedience.

God used:

- her identity
- her humility
- her courage
- her fasting
- her placement

...to preserve an entire people. This is not a coincidence. This is covenant protection in action.

 To-Go Box — Take This with You

God positions before He promotes.

Purpose requires courage.

Fasting unlocks clarity.

And obedience activates destiny.

Write one short spiritual nugget you’re taking with you:

Prayer

“Lord, thank You for divine placement and divine purpose. Strengthen us like Esther to stand boldly, speak wisely, and obey quickly—even when fear rises. Teach us to fast, to listen, and to move when You call. And remind us that You are the God who turns every evil plot into a testimony of Your power. In Jesus’ name, amen.”

Write a short prayer about one thing you want to start praying about:

Review Questions

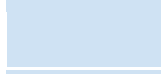
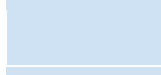
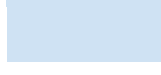
1. Who was King Ahasuerus’ first wife?

2. Why were the Jews’ lives threatened?

3. How long were they called to a fast?

4. What did Esther risk by going before the king unsummoned?

Activity – Mix & Match

Match	Name/Phrase	Description
	1 Haman	A Esther’s Cousin
	2 Mordecai	B Wanted to destroy Jews
	3 Vashti	C Death for coming without summons
	4 Why Fast was called	D Refused to come when summoned
	5 How Haman died	E By hanging at the Gallows

(Check the Appendix for answers)

Word Study

“King Ahasuerus” = Xerxes in some translations.

“Shushan” = Susa.

Practical counsel on fasting (consult pastor/doctor as applicable).



Notes & Group Discussion

BM1 — Lesson 2: Solomon

The Question That Unlocked a Legacy

 **Theme:** Prayer, the First Resort

 **Background Text:** 1 Kings 3:5–14; 2 Chron 1:7–12; 1 Kings 4:29–30

 **Key Verse:** 1 Kings 3:9 (WEB)

“Give your servant therefore an understanding heart to judge your people, that I may discern between good and evil; for who is able to judge this your great people?”

Appetizer — When God Says, “Ask Me for Anything”, 1 Kings 3:5–7

⁵ In Gibeon Yahweh appeared to Solomon in a dream by night; and God said, “Ask for what you want me to give you.” ⁶ Solomon said, “You have shown to your servant David my father great loving kindness, according as he walked before you in truth, righteousness, and uprightness of heart with you. You have kept for him this great loving kindness, that you have given him a son to sit on his throne, as it is today.

⁷ Now, Yahweh my God, you have made your servant king instead of David my father. I am just a little child. I don’t know how to go out or come in.

When God met Solomon in Gibeon, He didn’t start with a demand—He started with an invitation. Solomon could have asked for power, revenge, or riches. Instead, his first instinct was to talk with God about how to lead well. Before crowns and kingdoms, God tested the posture of his heart.

CST Reflection

Before greatness begins, God often tests the posture of the heart. When God hands us a “blank check” moment, what we ask for reveals what we truly value—comfort, control, or kingdom wisdom.

Reflection Question

When God gives you a blank check of opportunity, what would your prayer reveal about your heart’s priorities?



Main Course



Bite 1 — Humble Heart of a King, 1 Kings 3:9-10

⁹ Give your servant therefore an understanding heart to judge your people, that I may discern between good and evil; for who is able to judge this great people of yours? ¹⁰ This request pleased the Lord, that Solomon had asked this thing.

Solomon could have used prayer as a way to secure more comfort for himself. Instead, he asked for an understanding heart to serve God's people well. God was pleased, not because the words sounded spiritual, but because the request was selfless and aligned with His purposes.

□ CST

True prayer doesn't manipulate—it aligns. Solomon's request pleased God because it flowed from a heart that valued wisdom to serve over wealth to be seen.

Reflect:

How might your prayer life change if you sought God's heart before His hand?



Bite 2 — God's Response, 2 Chron 1:11–12

¹¹ God said to Solomon, "Because this was in your heart, and you have not asked riches, wealth, honor, or the life of those who hate you, nor yet have you asked for long life; but have asked for wisdom and knowledge for yourself, that you may judge my people, over whom I have made you king, ¹²therefore wisdom and knowledge is granted to you. I will give you riches, wealth, and honor, such as none of the kings have had who have been before you, and none after you will have."

God granted Solomon what he asked for—wisdom and understanding—and then added what he didn't ask for: riches, wealth, and honor. When wisdom comes first, blessings can follow without becoming idols. God can trust us with more when our heart is set on serving His people instead of promoting ourselves.

□ CST Reflection

God rewards those who seek understanding before abundance. When you desire wisdom more than you desire status, you make room for God to add what you never thought to ask for.

Reflect:

Where in your life do you feel pressure to chase “riches and honor” instead of asking first for wisdom to serve well?



Bite 3 — A Legacy That Starts in Prayer, 1 Kings 4:29–30

“God gave Solomon wisdom and understanding exceeding much, and very great understanding, even as the sand that is on the seashore. Solomon’s wisdom excelled the wisdom of all the children of the east, and all the wisdom of Egypt.”

Solomon’s wisdom became his reputation. People knew him not just for what he had, but for the way he thought, judged, and led. What began as a private conversation with God in a dream turned into a public legacy that reached the nations. Solomon’s story shows that legacy doesn’t begin on a platform—it begins in God’s presence.

Reflect

How could your private time with God today shape how people remember your life tomorrow?



Dessert — The Legacy of a Wise Heart

God gave Solomon abundant wisdom and understanding “like the sand that is on the seashore,” and his wisdom exceeded that of all the surrounding nations.

The story of Solomon reminds us that real greatness starts with a listening heart. When we ask for wisdom instead of applause, God can use our lives to bless people we may never meet.

□ CST Reflection

Finish this quietly: “Lord, help me want _____ more than _____.”
